BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #19 · AGING AND DECLINE

"I'm too old to change."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Habits and beliefs become comfortable over decades, and many hear "you can't teach an old dog new tricks." The result is resignation about patterns, health, relationships, or faith.

What Scripture teaches

"Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind." "Therefore, if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation." Paul said, "Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day." Caleb at 85 asked for a mountain (Joshua 14:10–12). Moses was 80 when God called him. Sarah and Abraham were old when God worked wonders. No one is too old for God to renew a heart or a habit.

> *"Therefore we do not lose heart. Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day"* (2 Corinthians 4:16).

Also see

> "Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind. Then you will be able to test and approve what is the good, pleasing, and perfect will of God" (Romans 12:2).

> "Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away. Behold, the new has come!" (2 Corinthians 5:17).

> "Even to your old age, I will be the same, and I will bear you up when you turn gray. I have made you, and I will carry you; I will sustain you and deliver you" (Isaiah 46:4).

> "In old age they will still bear fruit; healthy and green they will remain" (Psalm 92:14).

Common self-statements

- I have always been this way.
- It is too late for me.
- Change is for young people.
- I cannot learn new things.
- People my age do not change.
- Why bother?

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing people either change when young or never.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I cannot change.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling set and concluding that I cannot.
- Labeling: Calling myself too old.

Challenging questions

- What change do I want most?
- Have I ever changed something after age fifty or sixty?

- Whom do I know who changed late in life?
- What does Scripture say about God renewing us?
- What is the smallest step I could take?
- Who could support me in this change?

Truth summary

> Age does not limit God's power to renew me. I can learn, grow, and change with small steps and His help.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Thinking, Healthy
- Elderly
- Faith
- Wisdom
- Humility

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Suffering

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Do It Again — Steven Curtis Chapman
God's repeated gifts and new mercies express His continuing love.

Forever — Kari Jobe
Christ's resurrection grounds hope in His victory over sin and death.

Thrive — Casting Crowns
Life rooted in God includes purposeful growth and joy, not merely surviving or staying busy.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God's steady mercy through changing circumstances.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'm too old to change"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm too old to change." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What change do I want most?
- ☐ Have I ever changed something after age fifty or sixty?
- ☐ Whom do I know who changed late in life?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about God renewing us?
- ☐ What is the smallest step I could take?
- ☐ Who could support me in this change?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ My inner self is renewed daily.
- ☐ I am a new creation in Christ.
- ☐ My mind can be renewed.
- ☐ God works at any age.
- ☐ Small steps count.
- ☐ I can learn.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ 2 Corinthians 4:16
  "Therefore we do not lose heart. Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day."
- ☐ Romans 12:2
  "Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind. Then you will be able to test and approve what is the good, pleasing, and perfect will of God."
- ☐ 2 Corinthians 5:17
  "Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away. Behold, the new has come!"

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Growing still: Each week, note one thing you tried or learned.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, 2 Corinthians 4:16 becomes: "Sarah can write: "My inner self is being renewed day by day.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Elderly" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Pick one change. Choose a habit, belief, or skill.
- [ ] Take a small step. Do it for one week.
- [ ] Find support. Ask a friend to check in.
- [ ] Read Joshua 14:10–12. Be encouraged by Caleb.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm too old to change": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Growing still
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm too old to change.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You renew me day by day. Give me courage to learn and change, and thank You that it is never too late. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.